CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · NCERT-TYPE UNIT TEST SET 2

Chapters 9–12: **The Boy Who Broke the Bank, The Visitor (from The Book Thief), Helen Keller (poem) - Langston Hughes, The Stolen Bacillus** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. NCERT-type: questions in the style of the textbook examples and exercises.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The Bacteriologist says the slide has been 'stained and killed'. This means the bacteria were: 1

(a) stolen from a lab **(b)** grown in a flask
(c) kept alive in a tube **(d)** coloured with dye and made harmless

2. Jugal Kishore says he has no account with the bank, but: 1

(a) the Seth is his cousin **(b)** his son has one
(c) his neighbour has one **(d)** his wife has one

3. Mama first suggested hiding Max: 1

(a) in Frau Diller's shop **(b)** in Liesel's room, under the bed
(c) in the kitchen cupboard **(d)** in the attic

4. Why do the first two stanzas begin with just one word, 'She'? 1

(a) because the poet forgot the verb **(b)** to put the focus fully on Keller
(c) to rhyme with 'see' **(d)** to introduce a second person

5. What disturbing thought struck the Bacteriologist after the visitor left? 1

(a) that the slide was broken **(b)** that his wife was angry
(c) that the visitor may have taken the tube **(d)** that he had missed lunch

6. Which of these was one of the absurd rumours about Seth Govind Ram? 1

(a) He had opened a new school **(b)** He had fled the country
(c) He had donated all his money **(d)** He had joined the police

7. While the basement was measured, Rosa: 1

(a) went to the shop **(b)** cooked a feast
(c) laughed loudly **(d)** prayed in the corner, mouthing the words

8. Which of these best states the theme of the poem? 1

(a) beauty depends on clothes **(b)** true strength lies within the spirit
(c) fame is the goal of life **(d)** sight is the only way to see

9. When he meets the Bacteriologist in Wellington Street, the Anarchist greets him with: 1

(a) silence **(b)** a handshake **(c)** a defiant laugh **(d)** a bow

10. Seth Govind Ram is described as a man whose business dealings were haphazard. 'Haphazard' means: 1

(a) honest and careful **(b)** secret and illegal
(c) unorganised and careless **(d)** slow and steady

11. The 'good news' at the start of the extract is that: 1

(a) the war had ended
(b) school was closed
(c) a new ball had been found for the football game
(d) Max had left

12. According to 'Before You Read', Helen Keller became deaf and blind: 1

(a) at the age of fifty **(b)** during college
(c) in old age **(d)** in her infancy

13. Why does the Bacteriologist say scientists must keep living disease bacteria? 1

(a) to hide them
(b) to frighten visitors
(c) to sell them
(d) to study the actual living germs in the active state

14. Faiz Hussain nicked his customer's right ear because he: 1

(a) was in a hurry **(b)** was angry
(c) was startled by the news about the bank **(d)** was careless with the blade

15. The phrase 'a shemozzle of thoughts' describes the Hubermanns' minds as: 1

(a) confused and chaotic **(b)** cheerful
(c) calm and clear **(d)** sleepy

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Why did Liesel refuse Rudy's help at first? 2

17. What does the poet mean by 'the soul's own mastery'? 2

18. What does the visitor say about Anarchists in para 13? 2

19. What did the clerk say about the rumour that none of the employees had been paid? 2

20. Why did Rosa say, 'Maybe it will teach her a lesson'? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Did the Bacteriologist intentionally mislead the Anarchist? Why did he chase him? 3

22. How did Nathu react to the mess left outside the bank? 3

23. Why does Max apologise at the end? 3

24. How does the last stanza differ from the first two? 3

OR

Explain 'He greeted his pursuer with a defiant laugh.' 3

25. What does Sitaram's gesture towards Nathu teach us? 3

OR

How did Rudy unknowingly help Liesel's plan? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Write a news report of about 100 words on the protest outside the bank. 5

OR

What makes the extract suspenseful? Give examples. 5

27. Does this poem only apply to the disabled? Write a paragraph. 5

OR

Write an account of the chase through the streets and what each person believed during it. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 50 Marks

MASTERMIND